

"*Unfolding Origami* is a raw and psychologically honest memoir about grooming, coercion, and the ways young women are conditioned to silence their instincts in exchange for belonging. Galese explores the social dynamics of college, party culture, and Greek life that can blur the line between acceptance and danger, revealing how harmful systems are perpetuated under the guise of tradition, loyalty, and sisterhood."

—Lucy Taylor, Host, *SNAPPED: The Podcast*

During the first few months of my freshman year in college, I became entangled in a coercive, cult-like dynamic with my suitemates surrounding being sexually assaulted by someone related to a roommate, but the trauma didn't end there. I pledged a sorority whose hazing rituals eerily mirrored the powerlessness I had just survived.

The lines between fear, loyalty, and identity blurred, leaving me dissociated and questioning my own reality, and who I was. To cope, I turned to alcohol and pills, trying to numb the confusion and pain that no one seemed to see—or validate. Years later, sobriety opened a door to deeper healing.

Now a therapist, I began the difficult work of confronting my own trauma, engaging in intensive therapy to unravel the psychological programming that had kept me trapped in fear and disconnected from my intuition. This memoir reveals how easily someone can lose touch with their intuition when surrounded by groupthink and gaslighting. It's a story of reclaiming self-trust, recognizing coercion in unexpected places, and the long, nonlinear journey of healing.

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Cover Image by Joseph Stewart
Book Layout & Design by Angela Campbell



CAD \$23.95 | USD \$23.95

UNFOLDING ORIGAMI
A Memoir

LOREN GALESE, LPC, ACS



"Some wounds don't bleed—they fold you inward. Galese traces that quiet unraveling and the courageous work of unfolding back into yourself. This memoir is both a survival guide and a testament to transforming pain into something fiercely alive and meaningful."

—Sarah Edmondson, Podcast Host & Author of *A Little Bit Culty*

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